How to read this workbook

Project_Investor_Client_Economics_FINAL_AUDITED_2026-10-08_0649.xlsx · prepared 2026-10-08. Two to three minutes is enough.

What the workbook shows

What it costs us, in money paid to vendors, to serve **one client for one month** of AI-visibility monitoring, for three offering sizes, and how that cost compares with what competitors charge. It is an internal cost model at public list prices. It is not a price list, and it leaves out engineering, hosting staff, support and margin.

The sheets, in reading order

Sheet	What it is for
Investor Summary	The one-page answer: the monthly cost stack per tier, cost per tracked answer, what we can offer, what drives the cost and what is still unknown. If short of time, read only this.
Coverage	The AI surfaces (ChatGPT, Google AI Overviews, Gemini, Perplexity, Copilot, Claude …) we can monitor, which of the four competitors cover each one, and what one tracked answer costs us on each.
Client Tiers & Economics	The model itself. Sections 1–3 hold the **offering assumptions** (prompts, cadence, surfaces, volume); section 4 the **monthly cost to serve**; section 5 unit economics; section 6 a stress test of the Standard tier. Cell B30 selects the Actions option.
Actions & Models	The Recommendations layer, which is designed but not yet running: what the client gets, three priced options (Lower cost / Balanced / Higher quality), which AI models do the work, and why.
Market Benchmark	Competitors' public plan prices converted to price per tracked answer and per prompt, next to our cost on the same units.
30-Prompt Cost Breakdown	A **standalone measured example**: one real client onboarding of 30 prompts on ChatGPT, with every model call and token captured. It is the evidence behind the per-prompt rates; it is **not** the basis of the tier volumes.
Backup (hidden)	Every input, price, source and the arithmetic. Unhide it to trace any number.

Where to look

- **Offering / tier assumptions:** Client Tiers & Economics, rows 6–9 (prompts, cadence, runs, Oxylabs plan) and rows 12–21 (surfaces switched on); summarised in "Three client tiers" on the Investor Summary.
- **Total cost to serve a client (COGS):** Investor Summary rows 6–13, or Client Tiers & Economics row 38. Row 14 gives cost per tracked answer.
- **Actions / Recommendations cost:** the line inside the stack; the options and their drivers on Actions & Models.
- **Competitor context:** Market Benchmark; the ratio in H20–H21 is headroom, not a price recommendation.

The key outputs

Tier	Prompts × surfaces, daily	Cost / month	Per tracked answer
Small	50 × 3	$7.63	$0.0017
Standard	150 × 5	$36.98	$0.0016
Enterprise	350 × 7	$381.93	$0.0052

A **tracked answer** is one prompt asked on one surface on one day. Enterprise is dear because two of its seven surfaces (Claude through its API, Copilot through a second vendor) cost 4–14 times a scraped answer; the five core surfaces cost about $0.0015 each.

Actuals, estimates and scenarios

Every figure carries a grade in its "Basis / grade" or "Note" column:

- **ACTUAL** — measured: the tokens of the 14 model calls behind one onboarding, and the retry and check rates from 12 stored collection runs.
- **OFFICIAL VENDOR PRICING** — list prices read on the vendors' own pages (OpenAI, Anthropic, Google, Oxylabs, cloro), verified 2026-10-08.
- **CALCULATED** — arithmetic on the two above; this covers the whole monitoring stack for every tier.
- **ESTIMATED / ASSUMPTION** — not yet measured: all Actions-layer volumes (the layer has not run), tokens per Claude answer, hosting at $0, the 12-month spread of the one-time prompt build, ten clients sharing one Oxylabs plan, and the 2.8% retry rate applied to surfaces not yet wired. Section 6 of the Tiers sheet shows how far the Standard tier moves if these are wrong.

Colour code: blue text = input, yellow fill = the levers worth changing, green = linked from another sheet, black = formula. Change a blue cell on the Tiers sheet and every page follows.

How to interpret the outputs

- The headline costs are **usage at list prices**: no negotiated rates, no fixed costs, no margin. The Oxylabs plan minimum ($30 a month) is shared across clients and only matters while the company tracks fewer than 20,000 answers a month in total.
- Cost scales with **cadence × surfaces × prompts**; our own AI (building the prompt set) and the deterministic analysis are a rounding error, and the Actions layer adds a tenth of the Small tier and a few percent of Enterprise.
- Only the 30-prompt ChatGPT configuration has run in production; the other surfaces are priced from the vendors' rate cards, and no vendor discloses which model version answers a signed-out prompt.